

Participant Instructions

Project Title: Learning English as a second language in Chinese international students: The role of pre-task planning on second language writing performance (Project ID Number: 29617)

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These instructions aim to standardise the writing process for participants in the "no planning" condition. All participants in this condition will be informed of the contents of these instructions before the task begins and will be asked to provide informed consent to comply with them; participants may decide at their own discretion whether to continue participating in the task.

Under this condition, you will not be given separate planning time prior to the formal writing stage, but will proceed directly to writing. You will have 30 minutes to complete an assigned English argumentative essay of 200–250 words. During the writing process, no external resources or assistive tools may be used. You may finish and submit your task early at any time.

In the event of any discrepancy between the Chinese and English versions of this document, the English version shall prevail; the Chinese version is provided for reference only.

Guidelines and Rules for the Writing Task

(1) No planning condition: In this condition, you will not be given separate pre-writing planning time. Enter your assigned Subject code and Topic code, then click "Continue". Once you are ready, click "Start Task". The topic will be displayed, and you will directly enter the timed formal writing stage.

(2) Formal Writing Stage: You have 30 minutes to complete an English argumentative essay on the assigned topic, containing no fewer than 200 words (and no more than 250 words). During formal writing, separate scratch paper will not be provided for pre-task planning or pre-writing essay content. You may think, revise, and edit your essay normally within the formal writing interface. You must not use any external resources or assistive tools, including but not limited to:

- × AI;
- × Online searches;
- × Dictionaries or translation tools;
- × Sample essays or other reference materials;
- × Writing assistants such as Grammarly, Microsoft Editor, or LanguageTool.

(3) Finishing Early: If you complete the essay before the 30 minutes are up, you may click "Finish" to end the task early. Then, click "Download Data Package (.zip)" and send the data package (ZIP file) to the researcher.

(4) Regarding your writing logs: To study the writing process, the text produced during the formal writing stage, your revision process, and related writing logs will be saved for subsequent research analysis. These records will be used solely for research purposes and will be archived and handled in strict accordance with the relevant ethical requirements of the University of Melbourne, as detailed in the Consent Form.

IMPORTANT: Please ensure you have read and understood these rules before the task officially begins. Before participating in this study, you are also required to sign the Consent Form and read the Plain Language Statement provided by the researcher. If you have any other questions regarding this study, please seek further clarification or assistance from the researcher.